

Scenario interaction with Dossier Space with Leonard

Yes. This is an excellent **realistic dissonance scenario** because the court's question sounds simple:

"How many times did Person A communicate with Person B, and what was the essence of those exchanges?"

But almost every word creates an evidential choice.

Court scenario: communications between Person A and Person B

During cross-examination, a witness states:

"I hardly communicated with Person B about the transaction."

Counsel asks the court for time to test that evidence against the admitted email collection. The legal team instructs the Dossier Space:

Identify how many communications occurred between Person A and Person B during the relevant period, and describe the essential substance of those exchanges.

The result may be used to formulate further questions in cross-examination, but not initially as a finding of fact.

1. Matter intake

Before analysis begins, the human operator records:

Matter: Transaction Alpha

Question: How many communications occurred between Person A and Person B, and what was the essence of their exchanges?

People:

Person A = identified email addresses and aliases

Person B = identified email addresses and aliases

Period:

1 January–31 March 2024

Admitted material:

Specified email collection and attachments

Excluded material:

Privileged folders, personal accounts not admitted, and material outside the court-approved period

Communication types:

Direct emails, replies, forwards and copied messages

Initial threshold:

Litigation tier — minimum X=3, Y=3, Z=3

Intended use:

Assist counsel in deciding whether and how to continue cross-examination

This immediately exposes the first issue:

What counts as “communicated with”?

Possible interpretations include:

- A sent directly to B;
- B sent directly to A;
- one copied the other;
- both appeared in a group email;
- one forwarded the other’s words without sending to them;
- an assistant communicated on someone’s behalf;

- an attachment contained their earlier exchange;
- duplicated emails appeared in several mailboxes.

The human must define the initial rule rather than allowing Claude to silently choose one.

2. The proposed counting rule

A sensible first definition would be:

A communication counts when Person A or Person B is the sender and the other is named in the To or Cc fields of the same message.

The analysis should then report separate categories:

Direct A → B

Direct B → A

A → group including B

B → group including A

Copied-only communications

Possible indirect or forwarded communications

This is preferable to one apparently precise total that conceals different types of contact.

Conversation versus message

The court may also mean:

- **individual email records**, or
- **distinct exchanges or conversational threads**.

Ten messages in one email chain are not necessarily ten separate substantive communications.

The report should therefore provide both:

Unique message records: 34

Distinct conversational threads: 9

Substantive exchanges: 6

Administrative or duplicative messages: 3

These categories must be defined before the final count is presented.

3. Claude's pre-run plan

Claude would declare something like:

1. Confirm the admitted identities and aliases for Persons A and B.
2. Search message headers within the admitted date range.
3. Identify messages in which one is sender and the other is a recipient.
4. Retrieve the identified messages through the custody server.
5. Deduplicate messages using Message-ID, content hash and thread context.
6. Group remaining messages into conversational threads.
7. Distinguish substantive, administrative and copied-only contact.
8. Summarise the essence of each substantive exchange using cited passages.
9. Identify unresolved identity, scope or provenance issues.
10. Report counts by category rather than merging unlike communications.

This plan can be challenged before Claude begins reading content.

4. The Procedural axis in action

The custody server searches only:

- the admitted custodians;
- the declared dates;
- the permitted folders;
- the approved addresses and aliases.

Every search and message read is logged.

Suppose the search produces:

46 apparent message records

Claude then discovers:

- 8 are duplicates preserved in both mailboxes;
- 4 are automated calendar messages;
- 3 contain B only in a quoted historical chain;
- 2 are outside the date range but appeared because of quoted text;
- 1 belongs to a similarly named but different person.

The Procedural axis prevents these from being silently included.

It records what was excluded and why.

5. The ROMER analysis

Reasoning

The question is divided into:

1. How many qualifying communications occurred?
2. How many distinct exchanges did they represent?
3. What subjects were discussed?
4. What can safely be said about their significance?

Observations

The observations should remain close to the evidence:

Message E-014 was sent by A to B on 12 January.

Its subject line was “Revised valuation”.

A asked B to review figures before the Friday meeting.

Message E-019 was sent by B to A on 13 January.

B identified two assumptions that required revision.

Interpretation

Only after those observations are recorded should Claude state:

These two messages form part of a single exchange concerning preparation and revision of valuation figures before a scheduled meeting.

That is an interpretation, not a direct fact contained in either email.

Method

Claude records:

- search fields used;
- aliases included;
- date boundaries;
- deduplication method;
- thread-grouping method;
- classification criteria;
- treatment of quoted messages;
- treatment of Cc-only contact;
- treatment of attachments.

Evidence

Each substantive statement is tied to:

- exhibit or evidence identifier;
- path;
- Message-ID;
- date;
- sender and recipients;
- hash;
- relevant passage.

Results

A possible result might be:

Certain:

28 unique qualifying message records were identified.

Likely:

Those records represent 8 distinct conversational threads.

Certain:

Five threads concerned Transaction Alpha.

Likely:

The principal subjects were valuation assumptions, meeting preparation, document revisions, approval timing and concern about disclosure.

Unable to determine:

Whether A and B also communicated through telephone, personal accounts, messaging systems or intermediaries not contained in the admitted collection.

6. Describing the “essence” of exchanges

This is the most legally sensitive part.

Claude should not merely produce free-form summaries. Each exchange should be represented in a structured schedule:

Thread	Period	Direction	Messages	Evidential essence	Confidence
T01	12–13 Jan	A ↔ B	4	Review and revision of valuation assumptions before a meeting	Certain

Thread	Period	Direction	Messages	Evidential essence	Confidence
T02	28 Jan	B → A	2	B raised concern about whether supporting figures were complete	Likely
T03	4–7 Feb	A ↔ B	7	Discussion of when revised documents should be circulated	Certain
T04	19 Feb	A → B, copied group	3	Administrative arrangements with limited substantive content	Certain

The phrase “**evidential essence**” should mean:

A short, neutral description of the subject and apparent purpose of the exchange, derived from identified passages and separated from any conclusion about motive, honesty or legal effect.

Claude should not say:

“A and B conspired to conceal the valuation problem.”

unless the evidence and authorised legal analysis genuinely support that proposition.

It might safely say:

“The messages discuss whether revised valuation assumptions should be included before circulation. The correspondence does not itself establish why the participants preferred one timing over another.”

7. The planned dissonance

This scenario should deliberately include a difficult event.

During analysis, Claude finds a message from Person A to an unadmitted third party stating:

“I discussed this with B yesterday.”

That message is within A’s admitted mailbox, but the alleged A–B discussion itself is not present in the evidence collection.

This produces a genuine tension:

- **X says:** the system must not treat an absent communication as retrieved evidence.
- **Y says:** the message is relevant to the question because it indicates another communication may have occurred.
- **Z says:** the distinction and analytical choice must be open to challenge.

The proper result is:

HANGING THREAD / INDIRECT EVIDENCE

Evidence:

A told Person C that A had discussed the matter with B.

What this establishes:

A made a contemporaneous statement referring to a discussion with B.

What this does not establish:

The form, duration, precise content or accuracy of the alleged discussion.

Counting treatment:

Not included in the verified email-message count.

Recorded separately as one possible additional communication.

Status:

Possible — requires further evidence.

This is exactly where **perfect until it is not** becomes operational.

The system does not ignore the message because it complicates the count. It also does not convert it into a confirmed communication.

8. A second dissonance: identity ambiguity

Suppose Person B used:

- person.b@company.com
- pb@subsidiary.com
- an assistant's mailbox;
- the display name "Pat B."

Claude finds three messages involving pb@subsidiary.com, but the admitted identity schedule does not confirm that address belongs to B.

The result should be:

Verified communications: 28

Potential additional communications: 3

Reason not included: identity of pb@subsidiary.com not established within
the admitted matter configuration

Required decision: human confirmation or additional identity evidence

Counsel may authorise the alias after checking employment records. That correction is forward-only and the recount is filed as a superseding run.

9. Cross-examination output

Counsel does not need a 30-page technical report while the witness is waiting. The immediate court-facing output might be:

COURT ASSIST NOTE — PROVISIONAL

Within the admitted email collection and the period 1 January to

31 March 2024:

- 28 unique email messages were verified between the identified accounts
of Person A and Person B.

- These formed 8 distinct conversational threads.
- Five threads concerned Transaction Alpha.
- Their principal subjects were valuation assumptions, revision of supporting documents, meeting preparation, circulation timing and disclosure concerns.
- One further possible oral or uncollected communication is referred to indirectly but cannot be independently verified from the current material.
- Three additional messages remain excluded pending confirmation of an email alias attributed to Person B.

This analysis does not address communications outside the admitted collection, including telephone calls, personal accounts or messaging platforms.

This gives counsel responsible questions such as:

“You said you hardly communicated with Person B. The admitted email collection contains 28 unique messages between your identified accounts, grouped into eight exchanges. Do you accept that?”

Then:

“Five of those exchanges concerned Transaction Alpha, including the valuation assumptions and timing of revised documents. Was that evidence in your mind when you said you hardly communicated?”

The human advocate chooses the question. Claude supplies the defensible evidential basis.

10. What the pilot should measure

This scenario gives us several measurable tests:

- Did Claude count records, threads and substantive exchanges separately?
- Did it detect duplicates?

- Did it distinguish direct, copied and indirect communications?
- Did it keep observation separate from interpretation?
- Did it avoid treating quoted text as a new communication?
- Did it identify uncertain aliases?
- Did it expose references to absent communications?
- Did every summary map to identified evidence?
- Did Claude's declared accesses agree with the custody log?
- Did the exception remain useful without being falsely released as fact?
- Could another professional reconstruct the count without asking Claude?

The **correct answer is therefore not simply "28."**

The defensible answer is:

Twenty-eight verified message records, representing eight distinct exchanges, with clearly stated counting rules, separately identified uncertainties, and an evidence-linked account of what those exchanges concerned.